We saw the same trend starting to happen again, so we took the same approach; we had a cleanup sprint in 65 and managed to get the team stable and back in control with a much smaller hit than back in sprint 58.

Even though this data paints a pretty good picture of a problem and the effects of a change on a team, it's still only the tip of the iceberg. In the next chapter we'll start looking at even more data that you can add to your system and what it can tell you.

3.5. Summary

The project tracking system is the first place most people look for data to measure their teams. These systems are designed to track tasks, estimates, and bugs in your development lifecycle and alone they can give you a lot of insight into how your team is performing. In this chapter you learned:

- Your PTS contains a few main pieces of raw data: what, when, and who.
- The richer the raw data in the system, the more comprehensive the analysis. To enable this your team should follow these guidelines:
    - Always use the PTS.
    - Tag tasks with as much data as possible.
    - Estimate your work.
    - Clearly define the criteria for completion (done).
    - Retroactively tag tasks with how happy you were about them.
- Tagging tasks in your PTS allows you to analyze your data in novel ways.
- Adding a narrative gives context to changes over time.
- Velocity and burn down are a good starting point for analysis, but adding more data gives you a clearer picture of the trends you notice in those metrics.
- Pulling key data out of your PTS into a time-data series makes it easier to see how your team is performing.
- Just about anything can be distilled into a chart in your analytics system.